

Step 1

Admit you have a problem and are powerless over addiction/weight.

- (Romans 7:18) says ***“For I know that in me (that is, in my flesh,) dwells no good thing. I want to do what is right, but I can’t.***
 - (Proverbs 28:13) says ***“Whoever conceals their sins does not prosper, but the one who confesses and renounces them finds mercy.***
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The first step is **always** the hardest. Admitting that we are powerless and cannot overcome on our own is something that most people struggle with. Most have settled in their mind that "this is how it will always be and this is who I am"

We have believed and accepted what others have said about us as well as what we have told ourselves. Strangely enough, we have gotten comfortable believing this about ourselves. Therefore, we are convinced that what we are involved in, is not causing ***much*** harm to ourselves and those that love us, they just do not understand. The easiest way for us to look in the mirror is to deny the fact of what we have become and who we have become. We deny we have a problem that is leading us or has taken us down a path of despair, destruction, and very possibly death both spiritually as well as physically.

Jeremiah 6:14 TLB "You can't heal a wound by saying it's not there!" That is exactly what we are doing when we do not admit that we are powerless over our addiction or the weight in our life.

The opposite of Admitting is Denial. The following is an accurate acronym of what denial is and causes

Disables our feelings

By repressing our feelings, we freeze our emotions. Understanding and feeling our feelings is freedom. *2 Peter 2:19 AMP They promise them liberty (freedom), when they themselves are the slaves of depravity—for by whatever anyone is defeated and overcome, to that [person, thing, philosophy, or concept] he is continually enslaved.*

Energy lost

A side effect of our denial is anxiety. Anxiety causes us to waste precious energy running from our past and worrying about and dreading the future. It is only in the present, today, where positive change can occur.

Psalms 146:7-8 TLB He frees the prisoners... He lives the burden from those bent down beneath their loads

Negates growth

We are as sick as our secrets. We cannot grow in recovery until we are ready to step out of our denial into the truth

Psalms 107:13-14 NIV Then they cried to the Lord in their trouble, and he saved them from their distress. He brought them out of darkness, the utter darkness, and broke away their chains.

Isolates us from God

God's light shines on the truth. Our denial keeps us in the dark.

1John 1:5-7 NIV God is light; in him there is no darkness at all. If we claim to have fellowship with him and yet walk in the darkness, we lie and do not live out the truth. But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus, his Son, purifies us from all sin.

Alienates us from our relationships

Denial tells us we are getting away with it. We think no one knows, but they do.

Ephesians 4:25 TLB stop lying to each other, tell the truth, for we are parts of each other and when we lie to each other. We are hurting ourselves

Lengthens the pain

We have the false belief that denial protects us from our pain. In reality, denial allows our pain to fester and grow and turn into shame and guilt.

Jeremiah 30:17 NIV I will restore you to health and heal your wounds,' declares the Lord

The first step is absolutely essential for you to be an OverComer. You have to admit that you are powerless, unable to fix yourself. What you are powerless over and unable to fix, our Lord and savior, Jesus Christ is more than able and is very willing to do for you.

1. What areas of your life do you have power (control} over? Be specific.
2. What areas of your life are out of control, unmanageable ? Be specific.
3. How do you think taking this first step will help you?
4. How do you handle pain and disappointment?
5. How can you begin to address your denial?
6. In what areas of your life are you now beginning to face reality and break the effects of denial?
7. Are you starting to develop a support team? Are you asking for phone numbers at your meetings?

If not, this would be a good place for you to write that information down.